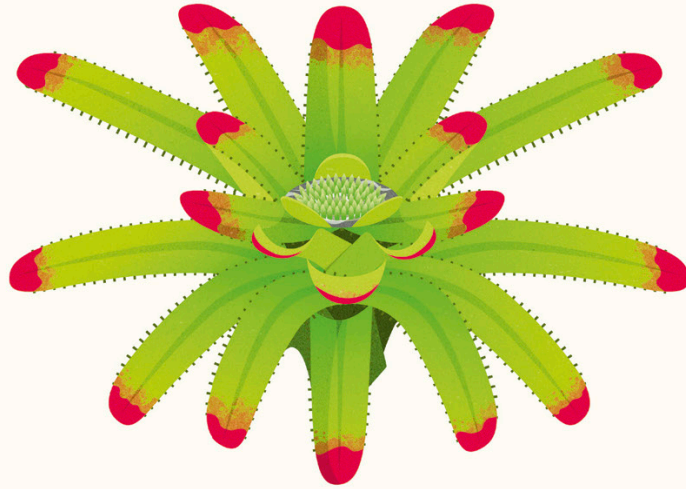


*Some bromeliads don't need trees to grow on –
they are happy to sit on artificial structures,
such as power lines.*



Bromeliad

In some rainforests, there are flower gardens in the trees. The flowers are bromeliads (bro-mee-lee-ads), and they perch high up on tree trunks and branches. Their waxy leaves grow in a flower-like cup and can be bright green, pink, or yellow. A bromeliad's actual flowers are very small and grow right in its centre.

How do bromeliads live without soil? It rains a lot in tropical forests, so the plants catch all the water they need from the air. The rain even trickles into the middle of their leaves and forms small ponds. These treetop tanks are home to tadpoles of frogs that climb up to lay their eggs there, and they are also home to tiny rainforest crabs!